

Operations Department
Shatava/Donahue
May 2026

Year-End Thank You:

As we write this May board report and look at the successful year we have had in the operations department, we have many people to thank. First, we need to thank all of our custodial and operations staff. This year has gone very well from a comfort and safety standpoint at all of our DCG buildings. Now we are far from where we want to be, but we are improving every day. This year, as directors, we have challenged our staff to improve, and they have stepped up and done great things. Our facilities not only look really good, but they are also functioning at a level we have not seen in years. The people make this work, and we are so thankful for the people we get to work with on the Operations team.

We would also like to thank the other departments in the district for their collaboration and support as we transitioned into our first years as directors. We have attempted many new things, and some have been successful while others need to be revisited. The key to success is for each department we work with to collaborate on improving the learning environment for our students and staff. This happens all the time, and it makes our district operate at a high level.

Summer Cleaning Prep-

As we enter the last few weeks of school, our custodial staff has started preparing their equipment and supplies for the transition to summer cleaning. As a department, we have spent some funds to improve the quality of our equipment, and we have started to look at purchasing consistent equipment across the district so that all staff are familiar with and can operate the equipment needed to perform their task.

The major change to our summer cleaning plan is a great opportunity for our custodial department to work as a collective and improve cohesion across the district.

Big Summer Projects-

As we sit right now, we have six projects that have gone out to bid or quote and have been approved for us to move forward. These projects are under the BOND referendum and the use of SAVE funds. The following will help lay out how the projects are being funded and who will be overseeing them in their different roles. DCG is the owner and will be overseeing every project we have, but some projects have an additional layer of a Construction Management company to support them.

These projects are all coming out of the BOND funds and will have DCI as the Construction Manager to help support the projects:

- North Ridge Secure Entry
- Dallas Center Elementary Secure Entry and Reno
- Fire Alarm Reno at North Ridge and Dallas Center Elementary

The next projects are using BOND funds for the project, but because of the scope of work, DCG will be acting as the construction manager on these projects:

- HVAC Controls upgrade at Dallas Center Elementary and North Ridge
- Playground Equipment upgrade at all elementaries

The next projects are using our SAVE fund for the project, and DCG will be acting as the construction managers for these projects:

- Dallas Center Civil Project
- Playground surfacing at all elementaries

The last project that will start this summer has not completed the bidding process, so we do not have the necessary documents to confirm when it will start. This project will be paid for out of SAVE funds, and DCG will act as the Construction Manager for this project:

- Video Board Project at Stadium

From the operations department, our goal is to have all 7 of these projects completed and buildings ready to go for the first day of school in August. We know this is a lot of work to get done, and we have a good plan going forward. We have been on-site with DCI to look at the logistics of staging and prepping for construction. We will be using June 2nd-5th as preparation days to ensure our equipment is secure and out of the way so construction can start. As a team, we think we are in a good position going into the summer.

Smaller Summer Projects-

Along with the larger projects we have underway, we still have some smaller projects that need to be completed. We will be doing some painting in all of our buildings, we will be upgrading entry carpet in all of our buildings, replacing concrete that has failed over the winter, getting furniture in some of our buildings, and doing some smaller construction projects at both Oak View and Heritage to meet a need in the buildings. As a department, we understand the importance of large projects, but also know that any small project we can get done will continue to improve the learning environment in our buildings.

This is going to be one of the busiest summers we have had, with almost all of our buildings affected by some form of construction. This is an exciting time for the district, and we are all excited to see the transformations that will come.

Bond Update-

We continue to work with our architect to finalize our designs for the Operations/IT building and the High School renovation. We are making good progress on the Operations/IT building and are hoping to have designs ready to go out to bid in the next few weeks. The nice thing about this project is that we are not tied to a school year; we can start this project whenever it works. The High School Design has reached the next step: we have to sit down, go through the first stage of design, and dive into the specifics of what we need for this project. There is still a lot of design work to get done on this project, but we are working through all the proper stages to ensure we are doing what is best for the district.

Sean Shatava
Director of Maintenance and Grounds

Travis Donahue
Director of Custodial Services and Buildings

